# Cleaning & Station Standards

# The C+ Standard

At C+, cleanliness is not a task — it is a **discipline**. It is inseparable from the quality of the coffee we serve. A meticulously prepared espresso loses all its meaning if it is served from a dirty, disorganised station. The brew bar is a stage, and every customer who walks through our door deserves to see a performance — precise, elegant, and spotless.

C+ is an **innovation in the specialty coffee industry**. Unlike ordinary coffee shops where speed often takes priority over substance, C+ represents a movement that places **quality above everything**. We do not rush. We respect the time the product demands. Every step in our process — from sourcing to roasting to extraction — is executed with intention and patience, because exceptional coffee cannot be hurried.

Mr. Asaad founded C+ on this conviction: specialty coffee deserves more than what the industry typically offers. C+ is not an ordinary coffee shop. It is a **new mentality** — one where every detail matters, from the grind size to the cleanliness of the counter. The product we serve is extraordinary. The environment in which we serve it must be equally extraordinary.

> **Non-Negotiable**
>
> A customer who arrives during the preparation of a drink must never see a messy brew bar. Clean as you go — always, without exception. This is a defining mark of C+.

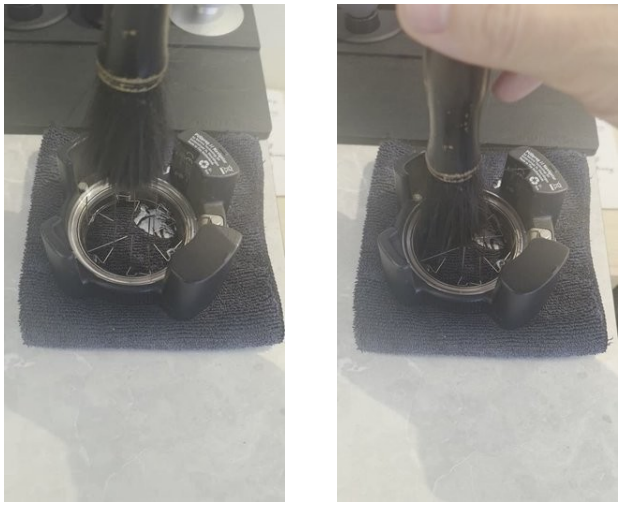
# 1. Clean As You Go — During the Workflow

The principle is simple: **every action leaves the station cleaner than you found it**. This does not mean you stop to deep-clean between orders. It means that brushing, wiping, and organising are woven into every step of your workflow, so naturally that they become invisible.

## 1.1 Espresso Workflow

After every single shot of espresso, the following must happen without exception:

- **Brush the counter —** Use the station brush to sweep all ground coffee from the work surface immediately after grinding and dosing. No loose grounds should remain visible on the counter, the tamping mat, or around the grinder. This is the single most important cleaning habit at C+.
- **Clean the Navigator —** After every shot, clean the PUQ Prep Navigator by gently inserting the brush vertically into the chamber and withdrawing it straight out. Repeat two to three times. **Do not brush aggressively or scrub the WDT needles sideways** — this can bend or damage the distribution pins. The motion should always be a gentle, vertical insertion and removal.



*Cleaning the PUQ Prep Navigator: insert the brush vertically and withdraw gently. Never scrub sideways.*

- **Knock and wipe the portafilter —** Knock the spent puck into the knock box. Wipe the basket interior with a dry cloth to remove residual oils and grounds.
- **Flush the group head —** Run a brief flush after every extraction. This purges residual coffee oils and prevents build-up on the shower screen.
- **Wipe the drip tray area —** Use the dedicated drip tray cloth to wipe any splashes or drips from the machine's drip tray and surrounding surfaces.
- **Return all tools to position —** The portafilter goes back onto the tamping mat. The brush, air blower, Navigator, distributor, and tamper return to their designated positions. Every item has a place.

**The Brush Rule**

The brush is your most-used tool after the portafilter itself. Every time you grind, every time you dose, every time you tamp — brush. It takes two seconds. There is no excuse for a counter covered in ground coffee.

## 1.2 Steam Wand — Health & Safety

For hygiene and health & safety compliance, C+ requires **two separate cloths** at the espresso station at all times:

- **Steam wand cloth (dedicated) —** Used exclusively for purging and wiping the steam wand. Purge the wand before and after every steam. Wipe immediately with the dedicated cloth while the wand is still warm. Never allow dried milk to accumulate on the wand tip.
- **Drip tray / surface cloth (dedicated) —** Used for wiping the drip tray, machine body, and surrounding counter surfaces. This cloth must never touch the steam wand.

*Both cloths must be replaced with clean ones regularly throughout the shift and at every shift change. Damp, dirty cloths are unacceptable.*

## 1.3 Filter Coffee & BIRD Workflow

The same standard of cleanliness applies to the filter station:

- **Brush after grinding —** After using the EG-1 for filter or BIRD, brush all loose grounds from the work surface, the scale area, and around the grinder base.
- **Wipe spills immediately —** Any water splashes from pouring, rinsing filters, or preheating must be wiped away at once.
- **Discard used filters promptly —** V60 and Chemex paper filters go into the compost bin immediately after brewing. BIRD Abaca filters and spent pucks are removed and disposed of right after serving.
- **Reset the station —** Return the server, brewer, and all accessories to their positions. The station should look ready for the next brew at all times.

## 1.4 Matcha & Tea Station

The matcha and tea preparation area requires the same level of care:

- **Wipe the chawan (matcha bowl) —** After each matcha preparation, rinse and wipe the bowl thoroughly. Residual matcha dries quickly and becomes difficult to remove.
- **Clean the chasen (bamboo whisk) —** Rinse the chasen with warm water after every use. Allow it to air-dry on its holder — never leave it sitting in water or resting on its bristles.

- **Keep containers sealed —** Matcha powder, tea leaves, and dried accompaniments must remain in their sealed containers when not in active use. This preserves freshness and keeps the station tidy.
- **Wipe down the surface —** Any powder residue or water drops must be wiped immediately. The dark counter shows every speck.

### 1.5 General Counter & Service Area

- **Counter surfaces —** Wipe down the entire visible counter at least once every 30 minutes during service, even if it appears clean. Customers notice details.
- **Cup organisation —** Cups must be placed side by side on the machine — never stacked. Replenish from the cabinet above the machine before they run out. Align cups symmetrically whenever possible.
- **Knock box —** Empty the knock box before it reaches half capacity. A full knock box is unsightly and creates odours.
- **Milk area —** Keep the milk fridge area clean and organised. Wipe any drips from milk bottles or jugs. Return milk to the fridge immediately after use.

## 2. Station Organisation — The C+ Standard

The photographs below show the expected state of each station. This is not aspirational — it is the baseline. Your station must look like this at all times during service.

## 2.1 Espresso Station (Slayer + EG-1 Black)

*The Slayer espresso machine with cups arranged side by side — no stacking. Cups are stored in the cabinet directly above the machine and can be easily placed on top as needed.*

**Cup arrangement:** Cups must be placed side by side on the machine — **never stacked**. Stacking creates a risk of breakage and looks untidy. Additional cups are stored in the cabinet directly above the machine and can be replenished quickly at any time. During service, cups will naturally be used — replenish and align them as reasonably as possible throughout the day. This is a matter of common sense, not rigid enforcement.

## 2.2 Espresso Grinder Station (EG-1 Black)

*The EG-1 Black with all tools in position: two portafilters on tamping mats, dosing cups, Navigator, Gravity Distributor, tamper, air blower, and brush. Every tool has a designated spot — maintain this layout at all times.*

## 2.3 Filter Station (EG-1 Silver)

*The EG-1 Silver dedicated to filter and BIRD brewing. Note the brush, scale, RDT spray, and dosing accessories — all positioned for efficient workflow with zero clutter.*

## 2.4 Matcha & Tea Station

*The matcha and tea station with chasen, chawan, tea strainer, and accompaniments. The dark counter demands constant attention — every speck of powder is visible.*

## 2.5 Milk Jugs — Colour Coding

*Milk jugs organised by type: lighter-coloured jugs for regular dairy milk, darker jugs for alternative milks (oat, soy, almond, etc.).*

At C+, milk jugs are colour-coded for quick identification and to prevent cross-contamination: **lighter / white jugs are for regular dairy milk**, and **darker / black jugs are for alternative milks** (oat, soy, almond, coconut, etc.). This distinction is important for customers with allergies or dietary requirements. Never mix jug types — a jug used for oat milk must not be used for dairy without thorough washing.

## 2.6 Cookies & Pastries Display

The presentation of cookies and pastries at C+ follows the same philosophy as everything else: **minimalist and elegant**. Mr. Asaad requires that the display communicates quality and intentionality. Each item is presented individually on a C+ branded plate, with a clear identification tag placed in front. The result is a clean, curated selection — not a cluttered bakery counter.

*The complete display at the Montreux store: each pastry on its own plate, evenly spaced, with C+ branded tags identifying every item. This is the standard.*

*Close-up of the pastries: Plié, Chocolate Croissant, and Croissant — each on a branded plate with parchment paper, tag in front.*

*The cookies section: each variety on its own plate with a descriptive tag. Note the clean spacing and consistent presentation.*

**Display rules:**

- **One item per plate —** Each cookie or pastry is presented individually on a C+ branded plate, placed on a small piece of parchment paper.
- **Tags always visible —** Every item must have its C+ branded identification tag placed directly in front. The tag shows the product name and description. Customers should never have to ask what something is.
- **Even spacing —** Items should be evenly distributed across the display. Avoid clustering items on one side or leaving large gaps.
- **Clean glass and surface —** The display glass and counter must be spotless. Wipe the glass and granite surface at least twice during service and always before closing.
- **Replace sold items —** When a pastry or cookie is sold, remove the empty plate and tag. If stock is available, replace immediately. If not, redistribute the remaining items for a balanced display.
- **Tongs and serving tools —** Tongs, spatula, and napkins must be clean and positioned neatly at the side of the display. Never handle food with bare hands.

*Note: The Montreux store serves as the reference standard. Each C+ location may have a different display layout due to the unique design of each store. Baristas are encouraged to adapt the presentation to their space while maintaining the same level of elegance and cleanliness. You know your store best — use good judgement.*

# 3. Opening Checklist

Complete every item before the first customer is served. The store must be fully operational and immaculate before doors open.

## 3.1 Espresso Station

- ☐ Turn on the espresso machine and allow adequate warm-up time
- ☐ Turn on the EG-1 Black (espresso) grinder
- ☐ Run a blank shot (water only) through each group head to flush the system
- ☐ Wipe down the entire machine body, drip tray, and surrounding counter
- ☐ Place fresh, clean cloths at the station: one for steam wand, one for surfaces
- ☐ Position portafilters on tamping mats with all tools in designated spots
- ☐ Place cups on the machine side by side (never stacked) — replenish from the cabinet above
- ☐ Prepare fresh milk jugs and stock the milk fridge
- ☐ Dial in espresso: pull test shots, taste, and adjust grind until satisfied
- ☐ Ensure the Acaia Lunar scale is charged and calibrated

## 3.2 Filter & BIRD Station

- ☐ Turn on the EG-1 Silver (filter) grinder
- ☐ Fill and turn on the Fellow Stagg EKG Pro kettle(s)
- ☐ Check filter paper stock (V60, Chemex, Abaca for BIRD)
- ☐ Wipe down the entire filter station counter and scale area
- ☐ Position the brush, RDT spray, and dosing accessories
- ☐ Verify MHW-3BOMBER scale is charged and calibrated
- ☐ Rinse all brewers (V60, Chemex, BIRD) with hot water
- ☐ Prepare a test brew if a new coffee bag is being opened — taste and adjust

## 3.3 Matcha & Tea Station

- ☐ Check matcha powder stock and freshness
- ☐ Rinse the chawan and position the chasen on its holder
- ☐ Organise tea containers and accompaniments

- ☐ Wipe down the entire station surface

### 3.4 Cookies & Pastries Display

- ☐ Set up each pastry and cookie on individual C+ branded plates with parchment paper
- ☐ Place identification tags in front of each item
- ☐ Ensure even spacing and balanced presentation across the display
- ☐ Clean the display glass and granite surface
- ☐ Position tongs, spatula, and napkins neatly at the side

### 3.5 General

- ☐ Wipe down all customer-facing surfaces, tables, and counters
- ☐ Check that the floor is clean and free of debris
- ☐ Verify all display items and menus are in place
- ☐ Check sugar, syrups, and accompaniments stock
- ☐ Ensure rubbish bins are empty and lined
- ☐ Verify water supply for all equipment
- ☐ Confirm Wi-Fi and music are on (if applicable)

## 4. Closing Checklist

The closing routine ensures the store is left in perfect condition for the next morning. Every item must be completed before leaving.

### 4.1 Espresso Station

- ☐ Perform a backflush with Cafeto detergent if 30+ shots were pulled (see section 5); otherwise water-only flush
- ☐ Remove, soak, and scrub the shower screens and baskets
- ☐ Wipe down the entire machine body, group heads, drip tray, and steam wands
- ☐ Empty, rinse, and clean the drip tray thoroughly
- ☐ Clean all portafilters — remove baskets, wash, dry, and reassemble
- ☐ Clean the PUQ Prep Navigator thoroughly — gentle vertical brush strokes only

- ☐ Discard all used cloths into the laundry — never leave used cloths at the station
- ☐ Empty and thoroughly clean the knock box
- ☐ Wipe down the EG-1 Black grinder exterior and clean the dosing area
- ☐ Remove both burr carriers, inspect, brush, and wipe with a dry cloth
- ☐ Brush and wipe the tamping mats
- ☐ Turn off the grinder
- ☐ Wipe down the entire counter, including edges and under equipment

## 4.2 Filter & BIRD Station

- ☐ Thoroughly clean all brewers (V60, Chemex, BIRD chamber, Pod, Claw)
- ☐ Wipe down the EG-1 Silver grinder exterior and clean the dosing area
- ☐ Remove both burr carriers, inspect, brush, and wipe with a dry cloth
- ☐ Clean and dry all scales
- ☐ Empty and clean kettles
- ☐ Turn off grinder and kettles
- ☐ Discard any remaining filter papers that are wet or damaged
- ☐ Wipe down the entire filter station counter

## 4.3 Matcha & Tea Station

- ☐ Rinse and dry the chawan thoroughly
- ☐ Rinse the chasen and place on its holder to air-dry
- ☐ Seal all tea containers and matcha tins
- ☐ Wipe down the entire station surface

## 4.4 Cookies & Pastries Display

- ☐ Remove all unsold pastries and cookies — follow storage or discard policy
- ☐ Remove all plates and tags from the display
- ☐ Clean the display glass inside and out
- ☐ Wipe the granite surface thoroughly
- ☐ Restock plates, tags, and parchment paper for the morning

### 4.5 General

- ☐ Store opened milk bottles in the fridge with the opening date written clearly on the bottle using a Sharpie or pen
- ☐ Clean and organise the milk fridge
- ☐ Wipe down all customer-facing surfaces and tables
- ☐ Sweep and mop the floor behind the bar
- ☐ Empty all rubbish bins and replace liners
- ☐ Restock supplies for the morning (cups, lids, napkins, filters)
- ☐ Final walkthrough: inspect the entire bar area from the customer's perspective

## 5. Deep Cleaning & Maintenance

Deep cleaning frequency at C+ is adapted to the volume of the store. As a boutique coffee shop, our volumes are lower than high-traffic locations, and we must be reasonable with the workload placed on baristas. However, when the store is busier, cleaning frequency increases accordingly.

### 5.1 Backflush (Cafeto)

C+ uses **Cafeto** as the cleaning detergent for backflushing. Cafeto is a professional espresso machine cleaner that removes accumulated coffee oils and residue from the group head, solenoid valve, and internal pathways. We also keep **Weber Spring Clean** available — a premium cleaning product by Weber Workshops designed specifically for high-end espresso equipment.

**Busy periods (30+ shots per day):** Backflush daily at the end of the last shift using Cafeto. This removes accumulated coffee oils from the group head, solenoid valve, and internal pathways.

**Quiet periods (fewer than 30 shots per day):** A daily detergent backflush is not necessary. A water-only flush at closing is sufficient — save the full detergent backflush for the end of the week.

> **The 30-Shot Rule**
>
> The threshold for daily detergent backflush is 30 shots. Below 30 shots per day, a water-only flush at closing keeps the machine clean, and a weekly detergent backflush is sufficient. Above 30, backflush with Cafeto every closing.

## 5.2 Shower Screens

**Busy periods:** Remove and clean shower screens daily at closing. Soak in hot water with a small amount of cleaning solution, scrub with a soft brush, rinse, dry, and reinstall.

**Quiet periods:** Clean shower screens at least 3 times per week. Even with low volume, coffee oils accumulate on the screen and will affect shot quality if neglected.

## 5.3 Grinder Maintenance (EG-1)

Follow the Weber Workshops EG-1 maintenance manual rigorously. Given C+'s boutique volumes, a full burr cleaning is not required as frequently as in a high-volume shop, but it must not be neglected. As a guideline:

- **Daily:** Wipe the exterior, clean the dosing cup and hopper area, and brush out loose grounds from around the exit chute. Additionally, remove both burr carriers (front and rear) and inspect the burrs for accumulated coffee. Brush all surfaces with the station brush and wipe with a **dry cloth only** — never use water or any liquid on the burrs. Reassemble carefully after cleaning.
- **Monthly:** Perform a more thorough inspection of the burrs for wear or damage. Brush out all retained grounds and fines from the burr chamber. Check alignment and recalibrate if necessary.
- **Quarterly:** Perform a thorough burr cleaning following the full EG-1 manual procedure. This includes removing both burrs, cleaning the burr chamber, and recalibrating if necessary.

## 5.4 Scale Care

Acaia Lunar and MHW-3BOMBER scales must be wiped clean after every shift. Never submerge scales in water. Remove any coffee residue or water droplets from the weighing platform. Charge scales fully at closing so they are ready for the next morning.

## 5.5 Kettle Descaling

Descale the Fellow Stagg EKG Pro kettle(s) monthly, or more frequently if you notice mineral build-up. Use a food-safe descaling solution. Rinse thoroughly after descaling — at least three full rinse cycles with clean water before resuming service.

# The C+ Mindset

Cleaning at C+ is not a chore to be done when you have time. It is an **integral part of the craft**. The way you maintain your station reflects the way you approach your coffee. A barista who tolerates a dirty counter will tolerate a mediocre shot. A barista who keeps an immaculate station is a barista who cares about every detail.

When you stand behind the brew bar at C+, you represent something different. You represent a commitment to excellence that goes beyond the cup. The customer sees your station before they taste your coffee. Make sure both are flawless.

**Remember**

Clean is not clean enough. At C+, the standard is immaculate.

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